

DOCUMENT 05

Build From Scratch Guide

Create a custom setup from zero — no reference photo required.

When to Build From Scratch

Use Build From Scratch when you have no reference image but know your target. You specify the pattern, subject type, environment, and gear constraints directly and NGW generates a full setup recommendation as if it had analyzed a reference.

Common Use Cases

- Teaching a named pattern without a reference photo.
- Reproducing a setup you remember but don't have documented.
- Testing how NGW handles your kit against a specific pattern.
- Pre-planning a shoot based on a style brief, not a specific image.

Step-by-Step Build Process

1

Choose a Pattern

Select from 30+ canonical patterns: loop, Rembrandt, clamshell, butterfly, split, hard, high-key, low-key, and more.

2

Set Subject Type

Specify portrait, headshot, product, editorial, or architectural. Affects modifier and distance suggestions.

3

Set Environment

Studio with controlled ceiling height, outdoor ambient, or hybrid. Affects power and fill recommendations.

Confirm Your Kit

4

NGW reads from My Kit automatically. Override specific items for this session only.

Set Constraints

5

Ceiling height, room width, power availability (battery vs. AC). All optional but improve ... output.

Generate Setup

6

NGW produces a full recommendation: lights, positions, modifiers, power, and checklist.

Launch Shoot Mode

7

Convert the generated setup directly into on-set steps.

Pattern Reference

Pattern	Shadow Direction	Key Position	Ideal Subject
Loop	Short loop under nose	45° off-axis, high	Most portraits
Rembrandt	Triangle cheek shadow	45°+ off-axis	Dramatic / editorial
Clamshell	Near-none (symmetric)	On-axis, above	Beauty / cosmetics
Butterfly	Butterfly nose shadow	On-axis, very high	Glamour / beauty
Split	Half-face shadow	90° side	High drama

Broad	Away from camera	45°, broad side	Slimming portraits
Short	Toward camera	45°, short side	Full-face emphasis
Hard Direct	Full frontal harsh	On-axis, flat	Editorial / fashion

IMPORTANT

- Build From Scratch outputs are based on canonical pattern definitions, not image analysis. Confidence will read as "Blueprint" rather than a percentage. Always run a test shot to validate against your actual environment.